

Parallel University

A Universal Musical

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PLOT SUMMARY

Parallel University is an interactive musical that follows an indecisive traveler who enrolls in this institution of higher dimension. Violet Agatha Bond is a high school graduate who is indecisive about life, opting for a nomadic meantime. As their journey starts to plateau while visiting Australia's plateaus, the locals summon parakeets to take Violet to a parallel world: Parallel University, home of the Parallel Parakeets.

The story starts with Violet Agatha Bond trying to find their true calling while travelling ("Where in the World Am I?"). After meeting the Australian locals, they camp out on a plateau ("When Life Plateaus"). These locals find Violet worthy of their secret world, so they summon parakeets after Violet. The parakeets surround Violet and speak for Violet from other universes ("Repeat After Me, After You"). The parakeets send Violet to Parallel University (PU) in the middle of their Portal games against Multiversity ("Teleport Lords - Parallel University's Fight Song").

Violet meets the university's president, Timi Lã. Timi Lã is the former Dean of PU's Journalism School. President Lã reveals the motto of Parallel University as: "Where the unchosen will be the chosen ones." The university provides Violet two contrasting parakeets/supervisors, Lo and Liu ("In Lieu Of").

Violet shares classes with their parallel counterparts: Roja, Orenji, Geel, Zelen, Mavi, and Indigo. Their relationships are dependent on the interactions that Violet chooses. A friendship with Roja leads to luck, Orenji leads to wealth, Geel leads to power, Zelen leads to harmony, Mavi leads to growth, and Indigo leads to puzzlement.

Their hardest instructor is Mira Gaitán, a genetics professor specialized in cloning and the bandleader of The Canaries. Gaitán opposes Violet's enrollment and will do anything to report on them in order to expel them ("Sing to the Police").

Their most compassionate instructor is Angie/Angus Caballero, an astrophysics professor. Their only child was killed during their enlistment in the air force when they had no choice in life. Caballero takes Violet under their wing because they do not want indecisions like their child's in life.

Their wildest instructor is Diên Nguyen, an archaeology professor who sends the students on messy assignments/adventures.

Parallel University is an interactive story that can go through different arcs with various conclusions.

Violet may drop out of or get expelled from Parallel University, returning to the nomadic life ("Stay Undecided").

Violet may get on Professor Gaitán's good grace and go into genetics ("In My Blood").

Violet may be encouraged by Professor Cabellero to go into astrophysics ("Our Stars Align").

Violet may go into archaeology or zoology due to Professor Nguyen ("The Fiasco You Know").

Violet may go into a) business from their relationships with Roja or Orenji, b) politics with Geel or Mavi, or c) music with Zelen or Indigo.

Violet may be drafted into the Parallel University's Portal team under Coach Delfina/Delfino. The team may win or lose against Alternate University at the annual Passiflora Bowl ("Teleport Lords - Parallel University's Fight Song").

Alongside Lo and Liu, Violet may undermine the entire university and get President Lã to resign due to their past journalistic malpractice ("Half-Truths").

Following the life of this indecisive student, physicist-turned-dramatist David Quang Pham alongside biology-based-composer Marie Incontrera spotlights the journey of self-discovery by role-playing and exploring mentor-student relationships, friendships, self-excellence, and higher education pitfalls with the musical, *Parallel University*.

CAST OF CHARACTERS

VIOLET AGATHA BOND, young adult, an undecided nomad

ROJA, young adult, a student with potential studying business

ORENJI, young adult, an affluent student studying business

GEEL, young adult, a power-hungry student studying politics

ZELEN, young adult, a popular student studying music

MAVI, young adult, a well-intentioned student studying politics

INDIGO, young adult, an experimental student studying music

Faculty

TIMI LÃ, adult, the president of Parallel University

MIRA GAITÁN, adult, a genetics professor and The Canaries singer

ANGIE/ANGUS CABALLERO, adult, an astrophysics professor

ĐIÊN NGUYEN, adult, an archaeology professor

DELFINA/DELFINO, adult, head Portal coach at Parallel University

Parakeets

LO, parakeet, Violet's supervisor who parrots good choices

LIU, parakeet, Violet's supervisor who parrots bad choices

VERBATIM, mascot, Parallel University's parakeet mascot

PARAKEETS, parakeets, Southeast Asian/Oceania parakeet ensemble

Ensemble

LOCALS, adults, the Australian locals who leads Violet to PU

STUDENTS, young adults, PU students and Parallel Parakeet fans

 Queer People of the Global Majority most represent the experiences of these characters; cast accordingly

MUSICAL NUMBERS

Definite

1. "Where in the World Am I" Violet, Locals
2. "When Life Plateaus" Violet, Locals
3. "Repeat After Me, After You" Violet, Parakeets
4. "Teleport Lords-Parallel University's Fight Song" Verbatim, Students
5. "In Lieu Of" Lo, Liu, Violet

Potential

- _. "Sing to the Police" Mira
- _. "Stay Undecided" Violet, Parakeets
- _. "In My Blood" Violet, Mira
- _. "Our Stars Align" Violet, Angie/Angus
- _. "The Fiasco You Know" Violet, Diên
- _. "Half-Truths" Violet, Timi